

❖ KITO ❖

retro collaborative music player · product specification

music player

youtube library

co-listening

retro aesthetic

pixel kittens

CONCEPT OVERVIEW

SEARCH PANEL

Search YouTube songs Browse queue / playlist

KITTEN CORNER (bottom-left)

Pixel cat = you Pixel cat = friend 1
Pixel cat = friend 2

VINYL PLAYER (centre)

Spinning disc · album art Play / pause / skip controls

INVITE / SESSION PANEL

Session link · friend list
Listening-together indicator

CORE FEATURES

Retro vinyl player

Animated spinning disc, retro UI skin, album art in the vinyl. Play, pause, skip, scrub controls.

YouTube music library

Search and stream any YouTube video as audio. Queue songs freely — no downloads needed.

Co-listening sessions

Invite friends via a session link. Everyone hears the same song in real-time sync.

Invite system

One-click shareable link. No account required for guests. Session ends when host leaves.

Pixel kitten avatars

Each listener gets a unique pixel-art cat in the bottom-left corner with idle, bopping, and dancing animations.

Song queue

Any user in a session can add songs. Host controls playback order and skipping.

TECH STACK RECOMMENDATION

Frontend	React + Tailwind CSS — fast to build retro UI, good animation support
YouTube audio	YouTube IFrame Player API — free, plays in-browser, no downloads
Real-time sync	Socket.io (Node.js) — broadcasts play/pause/seek/song events to all clients
Backend	Node.js + Express — lightweight, easy to host on Railway or Render
Sessions	In-memory session store (Redis optional) — each session = room ID + song state + user list
Pixel kittens	Hand-drawn sprites in Aseprite, exported as PNG spritesheets, animated with CSS keyframes
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Railway (backend + socket server)

BUILD PHASES

Phase 1 · MVP Core player · Retro UI layout (HTML/CSS) · YouTube embed + search · Vinyl disc animation · Play / pause / skip controls · Song queue (local)	Phase 2 · Social Co-listening · Node + Socket.io backend · Session room creation · Shareable invite link · Sync play/pause/seek events · Friend presence display	Phase 3 · Polish Kito vibe · Pixel kitten avatars · Cat idle/bop animations · Retro sound effects · Custom cat picker · Session chat (optional)
---	---	--

GET STARTED NOW

Start with the UI Build the vinyl player component in React first — nail the retro aesthetic before adding any backend.	YouTube IFrame API Embed a hidden YT player, control it via JS. No scraping or downloads needed — totally free.	Socket.io for sync Host presses play → emit event → all clients call <code>player.seekTo(ts) + player.playVideo()</code> at the same timestamp.
--	--	--

The trickiest part is the sync. When the host presses play or skips a song, your Node.js/Socket.io backend broadcasts that event to every client in the room, and each client calls `player.seekTo(timestamp)` + `player.playVideo()` — keeping everyone within ~100ms of each other.